

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 719 JULY 2009 PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Hikurangi Range, by Richard Davies
Winner of the 2009 NZAC Wellington Photo Competition

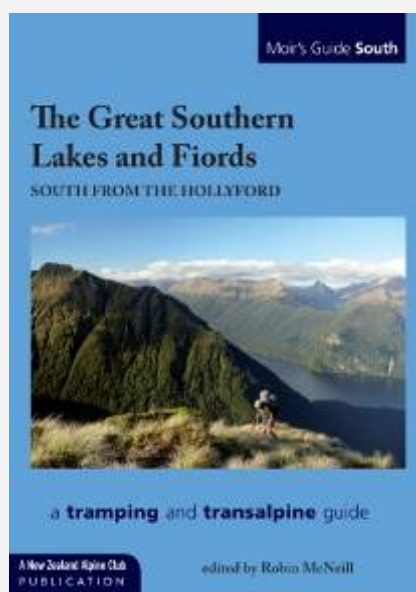
Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 6 July 2009

Uncle helps Moir do Fiordland, by Robin McNeill

Robin McNeill - author of Moir's South Guide and the very popular cookery column in the FMC Bulletin - will be speaking about his knowledge and experiences of the rugged wildernesses of the deep south.



The August section night will be on 3 August: North Face of the Eiger in Winter by Alex Palman

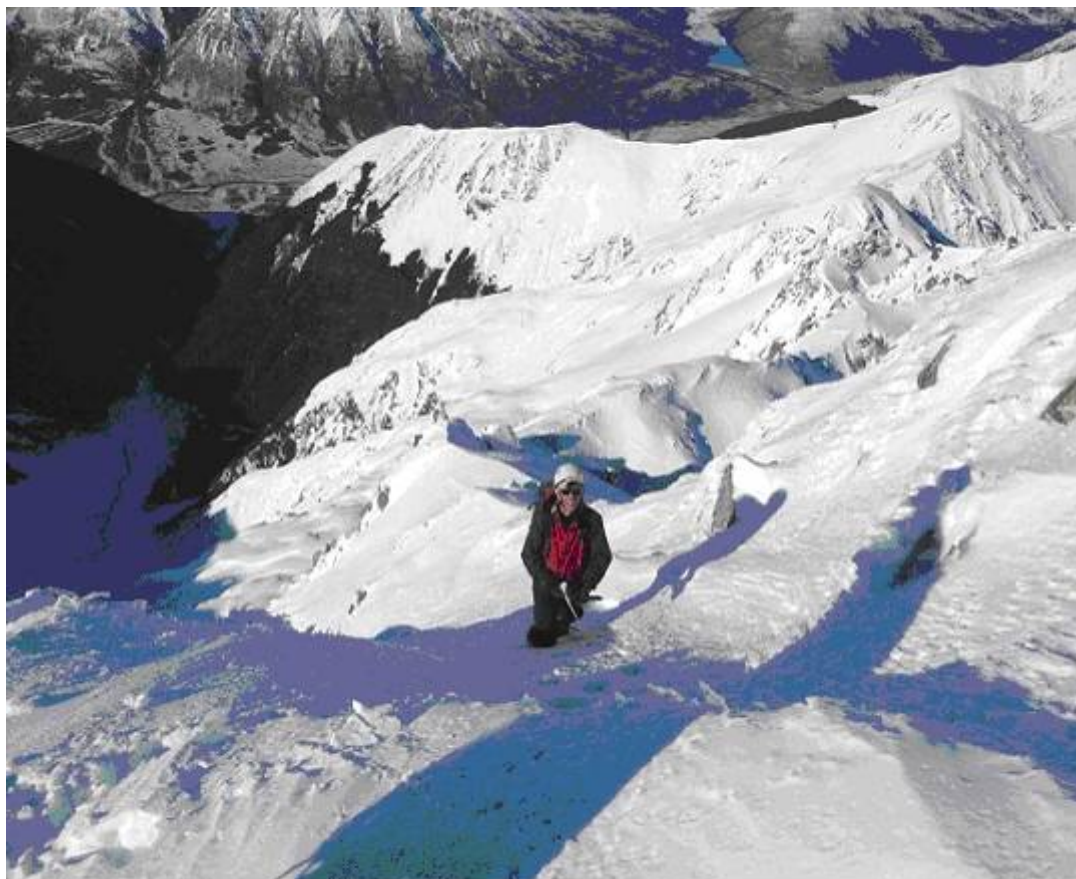


SECTION TRIP NEWS

Please send your trip reports and photos to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Spenserian Interlude

Over Sovereign's Holiday weekend Paul Maxim, Dave Grainger, Scott Miller and John Nankervis went up Cannibal Gorge and put in a high camp in the West Christopher in cold conditions. When the snow stopped they attempted Una directly from the Christopher via col with Duessa. Turned back after climbing the South Peak cos of conditions and time. As in Spenser's epic poem, *The Faerie Queene*, Una was the virginal heroine on the day.



Paul Maxim on Una

Wharepapa South – May 23/24

Finally, finally, FINALLY!!!! After postponing five times since February due to weather we got away on a club rock trip on the last weekend of May. Ten of us ventured north on a Friday night to Wharepapa South to sample the delights of Waikato ignimbrite.

Getting up for an 8am start we found it to be somewhat...frosty? Like 2C, like I thought I took up this sport to get away from freezing alpine starts. After 10 minutes on the Slug Wall (Froggat Edge) no one could move, all dexterity was lost to the fingers, and what looked like easy grade 15s became more like 19s.



Victoria, ShiChang, and Kevin discuss the first climbs of the morning. Photos by Tommi Kokki.

Still, it soon warmed up, and after an hour of sun and we were away. Lots of nice pockets, once you know where to look. Great exposure - after lunch the shirt even came off as we moved across into the Animal Biscuit Valley. My favourite climb = Bring Your Daughter to the Slaughter (18) a nice 25m overhanging arete with a tricky crux near the top (more like a 19). Also liked Firestarter (17) and Moonbase Alpha (17). Some good 15-25m routes here. A full blue sky day with a light southerly made for perfect climbing which we ran out fully till it got dark (5.30pm).

Day two was planned to be Castle Rock, but the rain had other ideas. So we bailed to Extreme Backpackers climbing wall in Turangi. Many of the routes had just been set so it took us a while to sort. One of the favourites had a huge 10m horizontal roof with big holds which had to be lead climbed - nice!!

Kev



Steve part way through his hour long jaunt
on Bring Your Daughter to the Slaughter



ShiChang's view on a frosty morning



Sunset – still climbing

Yep, while Kev's crew were up at the crack of dawn braving the icicles on Slug Wall, Catherine, Marcus, Melody, and Ralf had a slightly more civilized start to climbing, heading off to Bayley's Road for the day. Started the day heading cross country to Monday Wall to check out the climbs there while waiting for the sun to warm us up. A collection of climbs in the 15-20 grades with the odd 13 and 23 thrown in. After taking note of potential climbs to try, or not (Nose Route, 23 "lock off on two large pockets, dyno, and then its all over one way or another...") we headed back to the River Wall to climb in the sun, having the whole crag to ourselves.

Attack of the Killer Oven Gloves, 20/20, Stuffed Toys - Rabid Ones in Lycra, and Ones With Attitude, alongside Sharp Aretes (grades 16-21) kept us all occupied providing us with some doable climbs and ones that were a bit more challenging. The afternoon also saw Marcus take on Post Funeral Blues, a slimy 21 on the Roadside wall, and Ralph having a play on Swansong 20. By all accounts the Blues could've been a nice climb on a summer's day, but not recommended for last climb of the day on a chilly autumn day. Took another look at Gulp, the large chimney to the right of Post Funeral Blues, but recalling a less than pleasant experience on it on my previous visit and not having practiced my chimney climbing skills since, gave it a miss, ending the day.



Ralf, Melody, and Marcus relishing the autumn weather at Bailey's Road.
Photo by Marcus Manning.

As the rain set in on day two, and Kevin's car headed back to Welly via Turangi climbing wall, our crew headed back via Te Kuiti. With Mangaokewa only a short distance from Te Kuiti and beckoning us to "Come Sample the Steepness!" a detour was mandatory. As a

first time visit for all of our crew we were surprised by what we found. Having only really heard about the overhanging cliffs we were surprised to find a collection of easy grade climbs on the lower tier as well as the expected steep climbs sheltered from the rain. With the limestone cliffs hidden in the trees, it had a bit of a Paynes feel about it but a few degrees colder and minus the hippies. As we had already given up the idea of climbing for the day, this visit ended up just being a recce but one well worthwhile as we'd all made a mental note to come back another day.

Catherine



Ralf belays while the sun shines at Bailey's Road.
Photo by Marcus Manning.

Trip participants = ShiChang Hou (trip leader), Steve Minchin, Victoria Frenzel, Robin Maxwell, Kevin Patterson, Tommi Kokki, Catherine Moger, Marcus Manning, Melody Guy, Ralf Schwoerer.



2009 Wellington Section Photo Competition

Overall Champion

"The tussocks are like a painter's brushstrokes and the distance is shrouded in darkness. The poetic symbolism of a journey into the hills is well captured in this photo" – Marty



Hikurangi Range, by Richard Davies

Champion - Alpine General

"The elements read extremely well in high contrast black and white, showing all the elements of a group outing into the winter hills" – Marty



New Horizon, by Richard Young

Champion - Alpine Nature

"A jumble of shapes and forms of ice" – Marty



Ice Palace: Tasman from the the Trough, by Bruce Van Brunt

Champion - Humour

"I have to ask the obvious. Why is there a dog in the pack? It made me laugh the first time" – Marty



Dog in bag Tararua Peaks, by Nicky McIndoe

Champion - Photojournalism

"Peaceful, symbolic and landscapy" – Marty



Memorial boulder, by Helen Alderson

Champion - Rockclimbing

"I want to know more about this amazing formation" – Marty



No1 Lundy by Stephen Merchant

This year's competition was judged by Marty Blumen and kindly sponsored by:





UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Ruapehu South, Girdlestone & Tahurangi

Date: 3-5 July, 2009
Leader: Reece Geursen
Level: AIC Graduate and 0 - 3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Tahurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Tahurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier.

Contact Reece 976 8678 (evenings) or by email (rgeursen@gmail.com)



Tim Herwin, next to the summit of Tahurangi. Photo by Helen Alderson.



Ruapehu North, Te Heu Heu Dome & Paretetaitonga

Date: 7-9 August 2009
Leader: Robert Hawes
Level: AIC Graduate and 0 - 3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter.

Contact Robert at 027 447 0461 or by email (roberth@tfg.co.nz)



Arapiles, Victoria, Australia

Date: October(ish)
Leader: TBC
Level: All levels, all trad

The Arapiles is a legendary area for rock climbing in Australia. All trad, with a huge number and range of routes, there will be something for everyone on this trip. From three starred multipitch grade 5 climbs (yes, grade 5), through to bonkers grade 30+ routes with minimal pro, the Arapiles has it all.

At this stage this trip is only roughly planned – it will be a long weekend away, with current costs estimated to be in the order of \$600 per person.

If you're interested in finding out more about the Arapiles area check the following website: www.chockstone.org/Arapiles/Arapiles.htm

More details to follow...



CLASSIFIEDS



Andrew Lynch Estate Climbing and Outdoor Books

NZAC member Andrew Lynch passed away earlier this year. Andrew's climbing books are now being sold on behalf of his wife, with proceeds going to an Outward Bound Scholarship in Andrew's name.

Contact Shaun Barnett if you interested in buying any of the listed books – phone 976 2634, email blackrobin@clear.net.nz

Title	Author	Year	Condition	Price
NZ Mountaineering				
Hall & Ball, Kiwi mountaineers	Colin Monteath	1997	As new, hard cover	\$30
Unclimbed New Zealand	John Pascoe	1950	Good ex library hard cover, no jacket	\$30
Great days in NZ Mountaineering	John Pascoe	1958	Good hard cover, no jacket	\$25
Classic Peaks of New Zealand	Hugh Logan	2002	As new, soft cover	\$25
Mountain Recreation	Bruce Jenkinson	1976	Hard cover, dust jacket OK	\$20
Castles in the Air, Men and Mountains in New Zealand	Philip Temple	1973	Reasonable soft cover	\$15
Two Generations, Edmund and Peter Hillary	Edmund & Peter Hillary	1984	Good hard cover	\$15
High Adventure, Our Ascent of Everest	Edmund Hillary	2005	As new soft cover	\$10
Guide Aspiring	Frank Alack	1960	Ex library hard cover jacket	\$10
Dangerous Journeys, Graeme Dingle	Pat Booth	1995	Ex library hard cover jacket	\$10
No Mean Feat	Mark Inglis	2002	Ex library soft cover	\$5
NZ Alpine Journals				
1971, 73, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87	NZ Alpine Club		all soft cover, reasonable	\$5 each
1995, 97, 99, 2000, 2002, 2003, 2004, 2005, 2006, 2007, 2008	NZ Alpine Club		all soft cover, excellent	\$5 each
Photography				
Ways to the Wilderness, Great New Zealand Walking Tracks	Philip Temple	1977	good hard back	\$10
Overseas Mountaineering				
In Highest Nepal	Norman Hardie	1957	Ex library hard cover, jacket	\$25
World Mountaineering, great peaks by great mountaineers	Audrey Salkeld (editor)	1998	Good, hard cover	\$25
Collins Guide to Mountains and Mountaineering	John Cleare	1979	good hard cover, ex library	\$20
The Mountain Way, R L G Irving's Anthology	R L G Irving	1938	Hard cover, dust jacket	\$10
Himalayan Holiday, NZ Himalayan Expedition 1953	Athol Roberts et al	2004	As new soft cover	\$10
Within reach, My Everest Story	Mark Pfetzer, Jack Galvin	1998	Good soft cover	\$5

Into Thin Air, A Personal Account of the Everest Disaster	Jon Krakauer	1997	Good soft cover	\$5
Natural History/Park handbooks				
The Story of Egmont National Park	DoC	1990	good soft cover	\$5
Egmont National Park handbook	Egmont NP Board	1980	good soft cover	\$1
NZ Guidebooks				
Arthur's Pass to Mount Cook, A Tramping Guide	Sven Brabyn	1997	good soft cover	\$10
AA Book of New Zealand Walkways		1982	good hard cover	\$10
The Mount Cook Guidebook	Hugh Logan	1994	Good soft cover	\$5
Some Family Walks in Taranaki	D H Rawson	1984	soft cover	\$1
Leisure Walks, Rotorua/Taupo	Kathy Ombler	1996	Good soft cover	\$1
Tongariro & Taupo Walks	Alan Williamson	1985	soft cover	\$1
Overseas Manuals				
Alpine Climbing	John Barry	1995	Good soft cover	\$15
	Turlough Johnson & Madeleine			
Rock Climbing Basics	Hallden	1995	ex library soft cover	\$5
How To Rock Climb	John Long	1993	good soft cover	\$5
Climbing Terms and Techniques	Ken Crockett	1990	ex library hard cover	\$5
Snow and Ice Climbing	John Barry	1987	ex library hard cover	\$5
Travel				
The Kon-Tiki Expedition	Thor Heyerdahl	1952	Tidy hardback no dust jacket	\$5
Polar				
The Frozen Coast, Sea Kayaking the Antarctic Peninsula	Graham Charles et al	2004	as new hard cover	\$25
Arctic Dreams	Barry Lopez	1986	Good soft cover	\$10



NOTICES



Base Huts - New Youth and Day-Use Rates

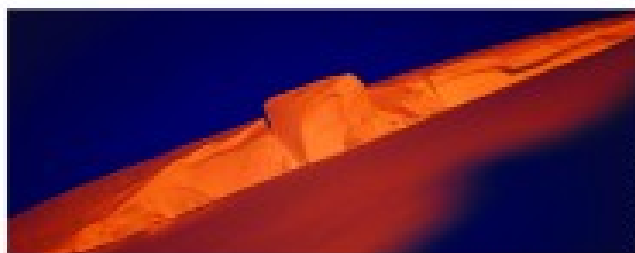
The following rates are now in place for base huts, apart from Unwin Lodge that has its own fee schedule. The changes have come about to encourage and assist members with young families and school groups. Fees are per person, per night.

- Children 10 years of age and under - free
- Youth Rate (11-17 years) - member's children \$5, non members children and school groups \$15
- Day-use rate - \$10 regardless of member status



2009 NZAC Photographic Competition

NEW ZEALAND ALPINE CLUB [2009] PHOTOGRAPHIC COMPETITION



The 2009 NZAC Photographic Competition is proudly sponsored by Marmot, Scarpa and Imagelab who are providing awesome prizes to the value of \$4,200.



Marmot
FOR LIFE



SCARPA

imagelab

Applications are now open and close on July 31. Judging will take place on August 13 and the results published in the Spring edition of The Climber, and on the NZAC website.

For the first time the competition includes a 'Youth' section, open to all keen young photographers (not just NZAC members) under 19 years on July 31st in the year of the competition.

The judges are three of New Zealand's premier outdoor photographers: Colin Monteath, Rob Brown and Dean McKenzie.

For more information, a preview of entries received to date, and the chance to see previous winners, go to <http://alpineclub.org.nz/photocomp>



NZAC Photo Competition Posters

The NZAC holds a national photographic competition each year to stimulate interest in mountain and rockclimbing photography and assist members to attain a higher standard of photography. Posters are produced using a selection of winners' images (H418mm x W590mm).

As a special we are offering two random past Photocomp posters for \$10, plus p&p, while stocks last. Brighten up your home, work, or class room with a selection of winning photographs.

For more information go to <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/nzac-photocomp-posters>



Climbing in Colombia

Climbing and mountaineering in Colombia. We can give you a hand organising the journey of your life!!! For more info check: www.escaladaencolombia.com.

If you need help with the translation contact: escalandoando@rocketmail.com or give me a call.

Leyla 021 02542231



ROCK CLIMBING



**Shed 6 Queens Wharf
Wellingtons Waterfront
Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896
wn@fergskayaks.co.nz
www.fergskayaks.co.nz**

Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail - Rental

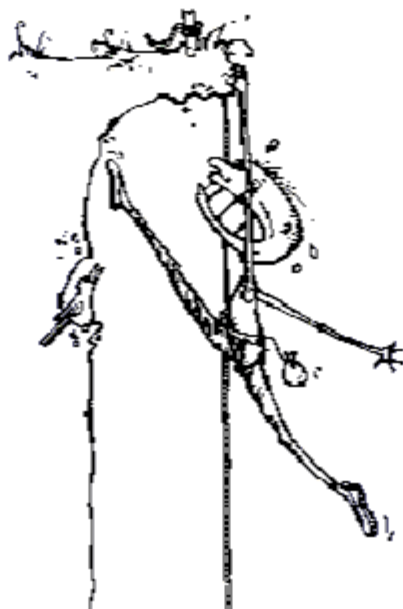
Alpine Club Members with card can climb any time for \$8

Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2009/10 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Gwen Rashbrooke	vicechair or GR	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	973 1307 (h) (021) 079 0854
Acting Treasurer	Richard Davies	Treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	(027) 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Scott Taylor	ST	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	934 0975 (h) (027) 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Louise Thornley	LT	
	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	Shichang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Max Gough	MG	
Other Roles:			
Gear	Blair Hiscoke	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	(06) 3777 117 (h) (027) 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	(03) 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

